

Later Wittgenstein — MCQ Questions

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MCQ 1

Which account best captures continuity and discontinuity between the early and later Wittgenstein?

A. The picture theory remains unchanged, while ordinary examples merely illustrate the same elementary propositions. B. The concern with language disappears, while a new metaphysical theory of mental objects replaces logical analysis entirely. C. The aim of clarification remains, while one logical form gives way to descriptions of diverse grammatical practices. D. The later work accepts verificationism, while the early work is recast as an empirical psychology of speech.

MCQ 2

Why is the colour-exclusion problem relevant to Wittgenstein's transition after the *Tractatus*?

A. Apparently elementary colour propositions exclude one another, pressuring the early requirement that elementary propositions be logically independent. B. The problem concerns private colour sensations alone, so it first appears within the diary argument of section 258. C. Colour incompatibility shows that propositions never picture facts, directly establishing the complete later philosophy as a complete semantic account. D. Colour words lack observable instances, proving that all ordinary propositions are metaphysical pseudostatements.

MCQ 3

Which provenance statement is accurate for an examination answer on *Philosophical Investigations*?

A. The work appeared in 1969 as notes on certainty, with Kripke responsible for its English translation. B. The work appeared posthumously in 1953, with Anscombe and Rhees as editors and Anscombe as translator. C. Wittgenstein published the completed work in 1921 with Russell's introduction and later withdrew its central thesis. D. The work was a Vienna Circle manifesto jointly issued by Wittgenstein, Schlick and Carnap in 1929.

MCQ 4

A candidate says that later Wittgenstein simply replaced an ideal language with a better ordinary-language theory. What is the best correction?

A. He kept philosophy's clarificatory aim but rejected one explanatory theory, using case-specific descriptions to dissolve confusion. B. He recast philosophy as an empirical study of verbal conduct, allowing observation to settle the conceptual questions left by logic. C. He treated ordinary conventions as authoritative rules whose stability provides a general theory of linguistic correctness. D. He transferred the Tractarian search for a single calculus to established ordinary usage, but treated that usage as the final explanatory system.

MCQ 5

Which ownership statement correctly separates Topic 08 from the two preceding topics?

A. Picture theory is owned by Topic 06 and verificationism by Topic 07, while their contrast with use is cross-linked here. B. Every question mentioning Wittgenstein belongs to Topic 08, regardless of whether it concerns the Tractatus or Investigations. C. Verificationism becomes a Later Wittgenstein doctrine because section 353 mentions asking how a proposition may be verified. D. The hierarchy of languages question belongs primarily here because later language-games also recognize multiple linguistic practices.

MCQ 6

What is the precise force of the qualification in Philosophical Investigations section 43?

A. Only names have meanings, while logical particles and avowals are convenient but strictly meaningless noises. B. Use replaces reference entirely, making it incorrect to say that a proper name ever refers to an individual. C. Every expression means only its statistically most frequent occurrence across all communities and historical periods. D. In many cases, meaning can be clarified through use, without claiming one universal reduction of meaning.

MCQ 7

Why does the toolbox analogy challenge the Augustinian picture of language?

A. Tools are useful only when privately imagined, so mental images supply the common foundation of linguistic understanding. B. A toolbox is a formal calculus whose rules determine every future sentence independently of training and circumstances. C. Every tool has one material bearer, proving that every meaningful expression must name a physical object. D. Different expressions perform different jobs, so naming is one linguistic function rather than the essence of every word.

MCQ 8

A teacher points to two red squares and says 'red'. Why does this not fix the word's meaning by itself?

A. The spoken label supplies a self-interpreting rule that fixes the sample as a colour standard rather than as an example of shape or number. B. The lesson succeeds chiefly when the sample resembles later red objects closely enough to guide analogical extension. C. Pointing helps, although training must establish whether colour, shape, number, material, position or another role is at issue. D. Pointing becomes determinate once the teacher's private intention selects colour, although the learner may initially misunderstand it.

MCQ 9

Which performance most directly displays understanding as mastery of a technique?

A. Experiencing a vivid inner image that no outward performance could ever confirm or disconfirm. B. Continuing a learned series appropriately while responding to correction across relevant new cases. C. Naming the private mental object that allegedly accompanies every competent utterance of the word. D. Reciting a dictionary sentence without being able to use the expression in any altered circumstance.

MCQ 10

How should the word 'Water!' be analysed in later Wittgenstein's method?

A. A relatively stable private image can accompany the word, but that image fixes its speech-act role across changing settings. B. Context lets each speaker negotiate a local meaning, with communal correction entering after the intended use has been formed. C. Its role varies with the language-game but remains answerable to shared practice, as in a request, warning or identification. D. Its primary meaning remains descriptive reference, while requests and warnings are pragmatically shortened descriptions.

MCQ 11

Which formulation best states family resemblance without converting it into a hidden essence?

A. A concept is legitimate only when philosophers can state necessary and sufficient conditions for every possible application. B. Instances need no similarities or learned boundaries because any object may belong to any concept at will. C. Instances are connected by overlapping and criss-crossing similarities, with no one feature required in every case. D. Every instance shares the single higher-order property of family resemblance, which functions as its real definition.

MCQ 12

What does the instruction 'Don't think, but look!' require in the investigation of a concept?

A. Survey actual cases and differences before imposing a theoretical essence that usage may not display. B. Avoid reasoning altogether and replace conceptual inquiry with passive visual observation of physical objects. C. Search introspection for the mental image shared by every competent user of the disputed expression. D. Accept the first familiar definition because ordinary speakers cannot be mistaken about their grammatical practices.

MCQ 13

Why do blurred boundaries not make a family-resemblance concept defective?

A. The absence of sharp boundaries means that correct and incorrect uses can never be distinguished in ordinary practice. B. Training and established applications can guide competent continuation without a sharp essence at every edge. C. Competence requires every speaker to draw exactly the same boundary in every imaginable borderline case. D. A blurred concept becomes meaningful only after science discovers the hidden property common to all its instances.

MCQ 14

How does family resemblance support the claim that language is composed of games?

A. It identifies picturing facts as the common feature shared by requests, jokes, prayers, reports and avowals. B. It permits diverse linguistic activities to count as language through overlapping relations rather than one common function. C. It proves that every linguistic activity is entertaining, competitive and governed by an explicit written rulebook. D. It shows that the term language-game is only decorative because language has a strict essence independently of use, despite actual usage.

MCQ 15

What does Wittgenstein's builders' example establish about a primitive language?

A. A four-word vocabulary is meaningful only if each word silently abbreviates a complete proposition in an ideal language. B. The example shows that all language-games reduce to issuing commands and obeying them within manual labour. C. The workers understand because each sound produces the same private image in both minds before any action occurs. D. A restricted order-and-response practice can be complete for its purpose without being a defective fragment of ordinary speech.

MCQ 16

Which account of language-game rules is most faithful to the later view?

A. Rules are private interpretations that determine use before any social training or observable correction occurs. B. A practice counts as a language-game only when all participants can state every governing rule propositionally. C. Calling language a game means speakers may revise meanings individually without standards or consequences. D. Rules may be implicit in training, correction and practice even when no complete written rulebook exists.

MCQ 17

Why can new language-games arise and old ones disappear without making meaning arbitrary?

A. Change occurs within shared techniques and purposes, although uptake and correction still distinguish innovation from failure. B. Meanings may change at the margins, although an underlying logical role fixes the core of each expression through historical shifts. C. New games become norm-governed when an institution codifies their rules, with informal usage serving mainly as preliminary experimentation. D. An innovation acquires meaning when a speaker forms a sufficiently determinate intention and others later infer the intended rule.

MCQ 18

A speaker uses a familiar sentence as a joke rather than as a report. What follows for its meaning?

A. The speaker's unexpressed intention alone fixes the joke even if no practice could distinguish it from a report. B. The sentence retains only its literal report because grammatical surface fixes one function independently of context. C. The surrounding activity and criteria of response help determine its role, so sentence form alone is insufficient. D. The joke is meaningless because only propositions that picture facts can participate in a genuine language-game.

MCQ 19

Which sequence correctly connects the main later-Wittgenstein concepts?

A. Plural uses support language-games, overlapping relations support family resemblance, and shared practice supports rule-following. B. Aspect-blindness supports ideal notation, ideal notation supports elementary propositions, and these establish public criteria. C. Verification supports forms of life, forms of life support protocol sentences, and protocols establish private language. D. Private ideas support reference, reference supports logical atomism, and logical atomism supports ordinary-language therapy.

MCQ 20

What does the statement 'To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life' primarily assert?

A. Language originates in a private imaginative act that subsequently projects meanings onto social behaviour. B. Each natural language embodies a complete metaphysical worldview that outsiders can never understand or criticize. C. Linguistic intelligibility is inseparable from patterns of activity, reaction, training and shared human life. D. A form of life is an explicit set of opinions accepted by majority vote within a linguistic community.

MCQ 21

How should agreement in form of life be distinguished from agreement in opinion?

A. A statistical majority's current preference determines truth and correctness in every disputed case. B. It concerns shared ways of acting and judging that make particular disagreements and corrections intelligible. C. It means every member accepts identical beliefs, values and theories before communication can begin. D. It is an innate logical structure that functions independently of bodily reactions, training and social practices.

MCQ 22

What is the safest interpretation of the remark that a speaking lion would not be understood?

A. Nonhuman animals are physically incapable of producing meaningful sounds under any possible circumstances. B. Translation between distinct human cultures is logically impossible because every culture has an inaccessible private grammar. C. Understanding requires identical inner images in speaker and hearer, which a lion could never reproduce. D. Shared vocabulary may be insufficient when forms of activity and natural reactions are radically different.

MCQ 23

When justification reaches 'This is simply what I do', what has happened?

A. Reasons have reached the practical bedrock of trained action, not an infallible private intuition or arbitrary preference. B. A metaphysical foundation has been discovered beneath practice and can be stated as a final explanatory proposition. C. The speaker has abandoned every standard, so any continuation now counts as equally correct within the game. D. The community has voted to stop inquiry, making the majority's behaviour logically immune from criticism.

MCQ 24

Which criticism of forms of life is strongest and still fair to Wittgenstein?

A. The notion denies all biological commonality and defines practices solely through consciously negotiated conventions. B. The notion proves that criticism across practices is impossible, which Wittgenstein explicitly presents as its main conclusion. C. The notion is under-specified between natural and cultural readings, creating pressure toward relativism without entailing it. D. The notion is incoherent because every meaningful sentence must instead picture an atomic fact through logical form.

MCQ 25

What generates the rule-following paradox in section 201?

A. Rules are generally vague sentences, and replacing them with longer sentences always eliminates the problem completely. B. Any finite action can be made to fit a rule under some interpretation, so interpretation alone cannot determine correctness. C. Communities disagree about rules, proving that correct application is whatever the largest group presently approves. D. No human behaviour displays regularity, so the very idea of repeated or customary action must be abandoned across cases.

MCQ 26

Why does adding a second rule fail to determine the application of a first rule?

A. The second rule is necessarily written in another natural language and therefore cannot contain any meaningful words. B. The second rule itself requires application, so an interpretation-based solution merely moves the regress one step. C. A community may recognize only one rule at a time, making combined standards sociologically impossible. D. Rules can guide action only when a private image accompanies them, and additional wording weakens that image.

MCQ 27

How does Wittgenstein preserve normativity after rejecting interpretation all the way down?

A. A private feeling of certainty fixes the rule even when no distinction between seeming and being right remains. B. An abstract rule-object causally produces the correct next action independently of learners and circumstances. C. Every regular sequence is correct simply because it occurs, so normative assessment reduces to behavioural frequency. D. Correct and incorrect continuation are exhibited within trained practices of teaching, correction and going on.

MCQ 28

What is the examiner-safe treatment of Kripke's reading of rule-following?

A. Reject every secondary interpretation without stating the problem it illuminates or the textual grounds for disagreement. B. Treat community assertibility as Wittgenstein's uncontested doctrine and omit section 201's description of a misunderstanding. C. Identify Kripke as an editor of Philosophical Investigations whose notes establish the official meaning of its remarks. D. Present the sceptical paradox and community solution as influential and contested, then distinguish them from the textual dissolution.

MCQ 29

Which case would most directly expose the difference between following a rule and merely acting regularly?

A. A speaker feels inwardly compelled to continue but cannot identify any circumstance in which the continuation would be wrong. B. A machine repeats an output pattern accidentally, although no distinction between error and correction applies to its operation. C. A learner responds to correction and extends the procedure to unfamiliar cases for reasons recognized within the practice. D. A crowd produces the same response repeatedly, so numerical convergence alone is treated as sufficient for correctness.

MCQ 30

How does rule-following prepare the critique of private language?

A. A sign needs a standard beyond present seeming despite absent observers, and private ostension supplies none. B. Communal agreement constitutes the truth of a rule and thereby determines whether the sensation named by it is present. C. Rule-following requires a contemporaneous social check despite allowing a person to execute the rule in physical solitude. D. The problem turns mainly on the diarist's fallible memory, so a reliable mnemonic device would secure the private sign's correctness.

MCQ 31

Which proposed language is private in Wittgenstein's strict target sense?

A. Signs whose meanings are fixed by sensations accessible in principle only to one speaker and unteachable to others. B. A person silently rehearsing ordinary sentences that other competent speakers could understand if they heard them. C. A natural language whose only remaining fluent speaker applies

inherited words in publicly learnable ways. D. A cipher used by one agent today but constructed from a public language and decipherable with the key.

MCQ 32

Why does the diary sign 'S' fail to acquire a private meaning?

A. Sensations change too quickly for memory, although a person with perfect memory could create the private rule. B. No independent standard distinguishes remembering the same sensation correctly from merely seeming to remember it correctly. C. The diarist cannot pronounce a one-letter sign clearly enough for it to function as a word in any language. D. The diary is written rather than spoken, and only vocal expressions can participate in language-games.

MCQ 33

What is established by the phrase 'whatever seems right to me is right' in the diary case?

A. Private certainty is the highest possible standard and therefore makes the sign more secure than public expressions. B. Public rules are valid only because most speakers happen to experience the same sensation when using a word. C. Every first-person avowal is false because no speaker can compare an inner state with another person's state. D. The distinction between correct and apparently correct application has collapsed, so talk of a rule loses its point.

MCQ 34

What is the role of the beetle-in-a-box analogy?

A. It restates the diary's memory problem and depends on each speaker checking the same private object over time. B. It establishes that inner experiences do not exist, since the imagined boxes may turn out to be empty. C. It proves that each person's sensation is qualitatively identical because everyone uses the same public word. D. It shows that a hidden private object cannot determine the public grammar of a sensation expression.

MCQ 35

How does the private-language argument bear on solipsism?

A. It undermines the attempt to state a world grounded solely in private experience because the required private signs lack standards. B. It accepts solipsism as true but recommends silence because private truths cannot be communicated conveniently. C. It proves by observation that other minds exist and therefore refutes every metaphysical form of idealism. D. It shows that public language mirrors identical private objects in all speakers, thereby guaranteeing interpersonal certainty.

MCQ 36

Does the private-language argument deny that a solitary person can follow rules?

- A. Yes, another observer must watch each application for any rule to exist at that moment. B. No, solitude is compatible with rules learned or sustained through public-type criteria and repeatable techniques. C. No, because private conviction replaces training once a person becomes physically isolated from society. D. Yes, because every language requires simultaneous conversation between at least two living speakers.

MCQ 37

Which objection most seriously tests the private-language argument from within its own concerns?

- A. The argument is false because introspection always reveals exactly the same qualitative state whenever a word recurs. B. Private sensations cannot be weighed on laboratory scales, so their existence should be rejected as scientifically meaningless. C. The argument fails because secret military codes are routinely spoken by only one authorized operator. D. A solitary speaker may preserve stable criteria through memory and practice, challenging whether social publicity is necessary.

MCQ 38

Which conclusion about inner experience follows from the private-language argument?

- A. Inner experience directly supplies private meanings, although those meanings become public only through translation. B. Inner experience is unknowable to the subject because first-person avowals require third-person behavioural evidence. C. Inner experience remains real and cannot alone fix the grammar and correctness of sensation words. D. Inner experience is unreal because only outwardly observable behaviour may exist within a scientific ontology.

MCQ 39

How does a criterion differ from a symptom in Wittgenstein's philosophy of psychology?

- A. A criterion is simply a symptom observed more frequently and with greater statistical reliability over time. B. A criterion is accessible only to the subject, while a symptom is any behaviour visible to another person. C. A criterion belongs to the grammar of applying a concept, while a symptom is an empirically discovered correlation. D. A criterion proves the presence of a state infallibly, while a symptom is always weak and dispensable evidence.

MCQ 40

Why does the defeasibility of pain criteria matter to the charge of behaviourism?

A. Pretence proves that first-person avowals are observational reports inferred from the speaker's own bodily movements. B. Because criteria sometimes fail, sensation words must ultimately be grounded in private ostensive definitions. C. Defeasibility shows that behaviour is irrelevant to pain concepts and may be removed from their grammar entirely within psychological discourse. D. Pain behaviour can be pretended or suppressed, so its criterial role does not make pain identical with behaviour.

MCQ 41

What does 'An inner process stands in need of outward criteria' most plausibly mean?

A. Only outward movements exist, while references to inner processes are false scientific hypotheses within a completed materialist psychology. B. Every genuine inner episode must produce one unique behaviour that establishes it with certainty. C. A subject knows pain by observing personal behaviour and inferring an inaccessible inner cause. D. Meaningful psychological discourse is grammatically anchored to public circumstances without denying inner processes.

MCQ 42

How should the first-person utterance 'I am in pain' normally be classified?

A. It functions as an avowal or learned expression of pain rather than a report inferred from behavioural criteria. B. The utterance is a third-person description abbreviated for convenience and governed by precisely the same evidential route. C. It is meaningless because the speaker alone has access to the sensation named by the word pain. D. The utterance is a hypothesis about a private object confirmed by comparing one's present behaviour with previous observations.

MCQ 43

Which position best describes Wittgenstein's middle route in philosophy of mind?

A. He accepts Cartesian private objects but supplements them with behaviour as indirect evidence for other minds. B. He eliminates sensations in favour of observable movements and treats first-person speech as theoretically dispensable. C. He makes each community's majority response constitutive of whether an individual genuinely experiences pain. D. He rejects private-object semantics and reductive behaviourism while retaining inner life and defeasible public criteria.

MCQ 44

What diagnosis is expressed by the phrase 'language goes on holiday'?

A. A word is detached from the ordinary practices that give it work, generating a misleading philosophical appearance. B. Every metaphor becomes meaningless whenever it departs from literal description of an observable fact. C. Natural language temporarily stops changing, allowing an ideal logical notation to replace it without loss. D. Speakers cease communicating during leisure, so philosophy must study language only in professional institutions.

MCQ 45

What is a perspicuous or surveyable representation intended to achieve?

A. It rearranges familiar uses so their connections become visible and a specific conceptual confusion can dissolve. B. It derives hidden metaphysical entities from ordinary sentences through a complete formal proof. C. It translates every language-game into one ideal notation whose logical form supplies its genuine meaning. D. It records statistically dominant usage and declares minority practices incorrect by definition.

MCQ 46

How should 'philosophy leaves everything as it is' be interpreted?

A. Philosophy must endorse every social institution and moral practice because criticism always misuses language. B. Philosophy does not reform ordinary grammar through theory and can change our view by dissolving confusion. C. Science supplies all truths, while philosophy merely repeats verified findings without conceptual analysis. D. Philosophical work is impossible, since any description would interfere with language and count as a forbidden thesis.

MCQ 47

What is the force of the fly-bottle image?

A. Ordinary speakers are irrational insects whose mistakes require correction by an expert scientific language. B. The image proves that all philosophical questions are meaningless under the verification principle. C. Therapy helps a thinker retrace the linguistic route into confusion until the apparent problem loses its grip. D. A philosophical theory should trap every possible objection inside a deductively closed system of propositions.

MCQ 48

What does the duck-rabbit illustrate in the discussion of aspect-seeing?

A. The unchanged figure can be experienced under different aspects, revealing perception shaped by conceptual mastery. B. Seeing an aspect is merely an inference stated after neutral perception and never belongs to visual experience. C. The physical drawing changes whenever attention shifts, so perception faithfully records a new external object. D. Only private images determine which animal is seen, making aspect reports instances of essentially private language.

MCQ 49

Which statement respects the ownership boundary for aspect-seeing and On Certainty?

A. They are directly examined in every Later Wittgenstein PYQ and therefore replace detailed study of language-games. B. They are bounded enrichments that may sharpen answers without displacing the three printed syllabus limbs. C. Aspect-seeing is a doctrine of the Tractatus because the duck-rabbit pictures two possible atomic facts simultaneously. D. Hinge certainty belongs to Topic 06 because Moore's propositions are discussed, so later analysis should never appear here.

MCQ 50

Can words generally be identified with ideas in the mind of the person who uses them?

A. Yes, because each meaningful word names one introspectible idea whose recurrence guarantees the same application. B. No, private ideas may accompany speech without determining correct use, which depends on techniques and criteria within language-games. C. No, because mental imagery never occurs and all psychological language should be eliminated in favour of behaviour. D. Yes, provided speakers report their ideas sincerely, since sincerity supplies a complete semantic rule.

MCQ 51

Which overall judgement best integrates the strengths and limits of Later Wittgenstein's project?

A. It makes meaning whatever communities happen to approve and therefore abolishes rational criticism across practices. B. It proves all metaphysical claims false by applying one universal criterion of cognitive meaning to every sentence. C. It supplies a complete empirical science of language whose predictions eliminate the need for philosophical criticism. D. It powerfully exposes semantic myths through practice, with unresolved questions about normativity, quietism and forms of life.